
MAC County Courier - March 6, 2026

From David Owen <dowen@mocounties.com>

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To Christopher Scott <cscott@callawaycounty.org>



The County Courier

March 6, 2026

Let counties be heard at the Capitol during MAC's Legislative Day

Registration for MAC's Legislative Day is open! Join county-elected officials on April 14-15 for an evening reception and morning at the Capitol.

[Click for the agenda and to register](#)



Join us for a Missouri Leadership Meeting with MAC General Lobbyist Trent Watson

Trent Watson, Lobbyist for MAC, will join the Missouri Leadership Meeting at 11 a.m. on Monday, March 23 by Zoom.

Watson will bring members up-to-date with the legislative session and where it stands at the halfway point.

How to Join:

This meeting will be held on Zoom. If you haven't already, please download the Zoom app to your computer or smartphone ahead of time. Simply use the provided link and wait to join the meeting on that day. You can also enter the



meeting ID to join if the link doesn't directly put you in the waiting room. Registration is not required for this meeting.

Meeting Etiquette:

Please keep your audio muted during the session. Submit questions you may have using the chat feature. Mark your calendar and get ready for an informative session. We look forward to seeing you in the meeting room!

Meeting information:

<https://us06web.zoom.us/j/85922574625>

Meeting ID: 859 2257 4625

MAC's bill tracker/Weekly Wrap Up

Stay informed on the progress of House and Senate bills being monitored by MAC during the 2026 Legislative Session and listen to the Weekly Wrap Up.

MAC's 2026 Legislative Bill Tracker provides a comprehensive overview of bills as they move through the legislative process. Visit MAC's website regularly to stay up to date on legislative developments throughout the session.

[Click to view the bill categories](#)

MAC's Weekly Wrap-Up provides comprehensive coverage of the key issues and initiatives that are currently being prioritized. From legislative updates and policy changes to important news and events, we ensure that you are well-informed about the matters that impact our counties and communities.

[Listen to the episodes](#)



Missouri News

Missouri House passes second attempt at legislation changing property tax policies

Missouri House members have passed legislation aimed at lowering property taxes.

Representatives voted 133-13 to pass the legislation. It now goes to the Senate, where Republican Senate Floor Leader Tony Luetkemeyer, R-Parkville, has already said reducing property taxes is a priority.

Speaking before the vote, bill sponsor Rep. Tim Taylor, R-Bunceton, praised the legislation and the work of the special committee he chaired on property taxes.

"If this passes this final journey, we can assure our constituents that we have made their lives better, and, quite frankly, made our lives better as taxpayers as well, in stabilizing the current system so that we can continue to work forward in the years to come to make it even better," Taylor said.

[Read more](#)



Judge revises ballot language for plan to make it harder to amend Missouri Constitution

A ballot measure pushed by Republicans to change how majorities are calculated in Missouri for constitutional amendments proposed by initiative must clearly alert voters that is its intent, a Cole County judge ruled Wednesday. [Read more](#)

Foes of new Missouri congressional map say they have signatures for a November vote

A group aiming to place a new Missouri congressional map up for a statewide vote says it will have enough signatures for a November referendum. [Read more](#)

Republicans push forward with proposal to replace Missouri income tax with sales tax

The proposal to eliminate the state income tax is moving to the Missouri House floor following a party-line committee vote Wednesday. [Read more](#)

Missouri lawmakers weigh \$294M price tag to carry out new federal Medicaid rules

Missouri lawmakers Wednesday once again discussed a request for \$294.6 million — including \$35 million in state general revenue — to help the state implement federally mandated changes to safety net programs. [Read more](#)

Shopping around for power: Missouri bill aims to break up electric utilities

Don Mayhew believes in the free market. “We have choice in a lot of different things. Go to a grocery store — there’s four different brands of green beans you can buy,” said Mayhew, a Republican Crocker. “We know that competition in any marketplace is the foundation — the cornerstone — of our capitalist system.” [Read more](#)

Missouri lawmakers told cost is unknown to fix problem-plagued financial system

A Missouri state accounting system that was supposed to integrate all state financial operations on one platform is late and over budget — and the program’s top executive can’t say when it will be working or how much more it will cost. [Read more](#)

Bill to create agriculture education program gets unanimous support from Missouri House

Hoping to grow the next generation of farmers, the Missouri House unanimously approved a bill Monday to create an optional agriculture education program for elementary schools. [Read more](#)

County News



'Blinded by dollar signs': Independence wrestles with 90% tax abatement for massive AI data center

Rachel Gonzalez did not foresee becoming an opposition leader to what could be the largest economic development project in the history of Independence, Missouri.

She is a lifelong resident, living just a few miles from a proposed hyperscale data center site. She knows and voted for several of the council members who will decide whether to give tax abatements to the project — a vote that may ultimately decide the fate of the "AI factory."

When she first heard about the data center late last year, she assumed the more she learned, the better she would feel about it.

The opposite happened. [Read more](#)

Property tax caps on April ballot in several counties worry districts

At the April 7 election, voters in several southwest Missouri counties will be asked to weigh in on property tax caps created by state legislators. As assessments and property tax bills have balloons, limiting how much property taxes can grow in the future could be enticing, but the constitutionality of the legislation is yet to be decided and the tax freezes could have significant effects on the services property taxes fund. [Read more](#)

Boone County considers ending renewal requirement for senior property tax program

The Boone County Commission is considering an amendment to the county's senior real estate tax program policy that would remove the requirement for annual renewal. [Read more](#)

Sam Page asks for \$8.6M for St. Louis County budget for jails, roads and police

St. Louis County Executive Sam Page said the county should add back \$8.6 million of expenses into its tight budget. [Read more](#)

Crusoe pitches 80% personal property tax abatement for data center project

The Warrenton Board of Aldermen listened to a proposal from Crusoe, the builder of the proposed data center in the city, for an 80 percent personal property tax abatement during a work session Feb. 23. [Read more](#)

Festus faces second lawsuit over data centers

A Festus resident has filed a lawsuit against the city of Festus, asking the courts to reverse recent City Council actions involving data centers. [Read more](#)

Share your county's achievements and honors

The Missouri Association of Counties would like you to Show Me Your County.

Show Me Your County is a chance for our counties to highlight a program, initiative or praise a hard-working county employee who has gone above and beyond their duties or has received an award.

Counties can submit a 500-word or less description of the program, initiative or employee, along with pictures if applicable. Those submissions will then be featured on MAC's social media platforms and in the Missouri County Record magazine.

SHOW ME
YOUR COUNTY

Submit your county today.

March

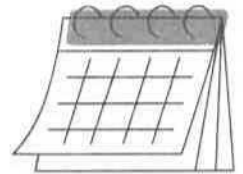
March 11-13- Sheriffs' Spring Conference
March 16-20 - Legislative Spring Break

April

April 1-3 - Prosecutors' Spring Training
April 3 - Good Friday/MAC office closes at noon
April 6 - Legislative Easter Break/No Session
April 7 - Official Election Day
April 14-15 - MAC Legislative Day
April 22-24 - Recorders' Training
April 21-23 - Collectors' Training
April 21-24 - Public Administrators' Training
April 22-24 - Auditors' Training

May

May 7 - MAC Board Meeting, Courtyard Marriott in Jefferson City
May 8 - State offices closed/Truman's Birthday
May 8 - Appropriation bills must be Truly Agreed and Finally Passed
May 15 - Session Ends
May 25 - State offices closed/Memorial Day



Schedule of upcoming webinars for NACo members

NACo hosts several webinars for its members that cover a variety of different topics and programs for county government officials and their staff. Learn about the upcoming webinars and register to attend.

[View the webinars and register](#)

NACo partners with thought leaders, industry partners and philanthropic organizations to identify and elevate best practices in key areas of county responsibility. NACo programming enhances public understanding of county government and supports the learning and development of America's county leaders.





Governor Kehoe announces opportunity for more Missouri communities to earn Blue Shield designation

Governor Mike Kehoe announced Missouri counties, towns, and cities can now apply to be recognized as Blue Shield communities in 2026 for their dedication to effective law enforcement and community safety.

The Missouri Department of Public Safety administers the Blue Shield Program. Applications should be made by an official from the jurisdictions seeking the Blue Shield designation in coordination with the jurisdiction's chief law enforcement officer.

Deadline to submit is June 1, 2026. Applications are made online, and all supporting materials can be [uploaded here](#).

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